The Godhead

Purpose: *To show the Father, Son and the Holy Spirit are a unity of 3 co-eternal persons.*

Centred on: *Jesus, Love and unity*

God is Plural

Gen 1:1, 2, 26-28…God is Plural

Gen 11:1-9, especially v7 add 6:3…God is plural

Gen 18:1-4, 16-33; 19:1-5, 12-25, especially v24…God is plural

Old Testament Suggestions

Numbers 6:22-27; Isaiah 6:1-5, especially v3; Isaiah 9:6…Suggestions in the OT

God is One

Deuteronomy 6:4…God is one. Remember Moses wrote Genesis and Deut. The oneness here in Deut must be compatible with the plurality of Genesis.

Equality

John 5:17, 18; 8:56-59; 10:15, 30-33; 17:5,11,20-22…Jesus claimed equality with the Father

Jesus is God

John 1:1-3, 14…The beginning was Jesus was God

Matthew 1:21-23…God with us, Matthew 22:41-46…must understand in order to explain properly

Hebrews 1:1-9…Father calls Jesus God

Col 2:9…All the fullness

Matthew 3:13-17…Baptism of Jesus

The Holy Spirit

John 16:7…Jesus declares that the Holy Spirit is a **divine person** by calling the Spirit "Him" not "it".

John 16:8…The Holy Spirit **convicts of Sin.**

Matthew 28:19,20…The Holy Spirit is **part of the Godhead**.

Ephesians 4:30…The Holy Spirit **can be Grieved**.

Genesis 6:3…The Holy Spirit **"strives" with us**, leading us to do right.

Romans 8:26,27…The Holy Spirit **intercedes for us**, and has a mind.

Romans 8:16…The Spirit **bears witness** that we are Children of God.

Galations 5:22-26…The Holy Spirit **produces His fruits** in our lives.

Ezekiel 36:26,27…The Holy Spirit **works a transformation of Character**, giving us a new heart.

Genesis 1:2…The Spirit **participated with the Father and Son in creation** and he participates in **re-creation**

Rom 8:11…We need not fear death, **for Jesus, through the power of the Holy Spirit**, will resurrect his faithful people.

John 16:13,14…The Holy Spirit **guides us into all truth**.

John 14:26…The Holy Spirit is **God's teacher**.

Matthew 12:31,32…To fully reject the **convicting, converting, instructing power** of the Holy Spirit continually is to everlastingly commit the unpardonable sin.

Romans 8:14…As we allow the Holy Spirit **to lead us**, we become Sons and Daughters of God.

Defend it:-

Jesus as God… Power to read human hearts (John 2:24,25); Power to foretell future (John 13:19); Creative Power (John 6:1-20); Power to give life (John 5:21,28,29); Infallibilty of utterance (John 8:46); Power to forgive sins (Mark 2:1-12); Power and right to receive worship (Matt 14:33, 28:17); Power to raise the dead (John 5:25,28,29; Jn 11); Power to transform hearts (John 1:12,13)

Jehovah's Witnesses

There is only one God Jehovah: Jesus is a lesser god proceeding forth from the Father. **To meet this error please note the following:**

a. **Either Jesus is fully God or not God at all**. (Isa 43:10)

b. **Who Is Jehovah?**

Jehovah Is	**Jesus is**
Glory (Isa. 42:8)	Glory (Matt. 16:27)
Creator (Isa. 40:28)	Creator (Eph. 3:9)
Redeemer (Isa. 33:22)	Redeemer (Acts 4:12)
Judge (Isa. 33:22)	Judge (Jn. 5:22)
King (Isa. 33:22)	King (Rev. 19:11-16)
Rock (Deut. 32:3,4)	Rock (1 Cor. 10:4)
Beginning and Ending (Isa. 41:4)	Beginning and Ending (Rev. 1:8-11)

c. These texts indicate that the **New Testament uses the same descriptions of Jesus as the Old Testament does for Jehovah**. Jehovah is the family name for God, sometimes applying to the Father but encompassing also the work of His son. Deut. 6:4 declares the Lord (Jehovah) our God (Elohim, plural) is one (Echadcompound unity indicating the fusion of two equals like day and night for one day, or man and woman one flesh) is one (compound unity) Jehovah.

d. **Who Is Jesus?**

(1.) Testimony of Prophet Isaiah (Isa. 9:6).
(2.) Testimony of angels (Matt. 1:21).
(3.) Testimony of Thomas (Jn. 20:26-28).
(4.) Testimony of Jews (Lk. 5:21; Jn. 10:33).
(5.) Testimony of Jesus "I AM" (Jn. 8:58,59). "I AM" is the self-existent one only applied to Jehovah (Ex. 3:14).
(6.) Testimony of the Father (Heb. 1:7-9). The Father calls the Son God.

e. **Jesus as first born** (compare Col. 1:15 with Heb. 1:6).

(1.) Jesus is called the first born from the dead. Was Jesus the first person to be resurrected from the dead? No (Lk. 7:11-15; 8:41,42,49-55; Jn. 11:38-44).
(2.) Obviously first-born from the dead does not mean the one raised first but the one raised with the special privilege of power over death.
(3.) David was the youngest son of Jesse but said to be the first born (Ps. 89:20,27).
(4.) The Greek word "Prototokos" means first born in the sense of privilege, not chronological order. It refers to first born in the sense that Jesus has the rights, privileges, and authority of the first born. In ancient Israel first born had the privilege of representing the Father. Jesus came to reveal God's glory (Jn. 14:9).

f. **Jesus as the Only Begotten**. Jn. 3:16 -the Greek word is Monogenes which means "One of a Kind" or "Unique One." Jesus is unique in all of creation. He is one of a kind-the divine son of God, the eternal one dwelling in human flesh revealing the Father in our midst.

g. **Jesus as beginning of the creation of God**.

(1.) Beginning of creation of God--the Greek word is Arche. Jesus is the beginner or origin of God's creation (Rev.3:14).
(2.) All things were made by Him (Jn. 1:3).
(3.) By Him all things were created (Col. 1:16,17; Heb. 11:3).